

ancient dreams, but they still conversed with them on occasion. Now the desperate Menehune called upon them for mutual protection and the spirits answered their call, aware that many of them entered slumber as the wall between the spirit world and the material world grew stronger with the arrival of the Europeans. They taught the Menehune the way of the Pact, by which a being could wed its soul to a spirit and claim that spirit as its totem. The totem spirits offered their connection to the spirit world, while the Menehune swore to uphold the laws of the totems. This gave the Menehune some protection from Banality and bought them some time, but it was not enough. The pace had slowed, but the Menehune continued to fade.

An Unlikely Savior

Salvation came from a very unlikely source. Among the whalers who visited the islands as a nocker seaman, named Jack Doggins. Jack loved the sea, and found the superstitious sailors to be an excellent source of Glamour, especially on moonlit nights when sea shanties spilled from drunken lips. The excitement they felt during a whale hunt was ecstatic.

Jack came across a lone Menehune as he walked the beaches of Kaua'i at night, admiring the lush beauty of the island after months at sea. He was shocked and amazed to find himself in the presence of a true fae, beings he thought to be long gone. How had such a creature survived? He babbled out a dozen questions before the Menehune even realized that he was in the presence of one of his own kind. The Menehune marveled at how this fae being could survive contact with Banal humans during long voyages on the sea. The walked along the beach for hours, sharing stories, and as the morning light began to glow in the east, Jack accepted an invitation to meet the chiefs back at the Menehune village.

Jack ended up spending many months among the Menehune, sharing all he knew of the Kithain, only occasionally slipping off to spend a night in one of the coastal human towns to gather a little Glamour. The Menehune shared their plight with him, and he saw firsthand the withering effects of Banality on them. In exchange for their hospitality, Jack Doggins taught the Menehune the Changeling Way — the trick of taking human form, of being birthed over many generations in human bodies to protect themselves from Banality. How Jack taught them this trick is unknown, but the Menehune revere him to this day and a heiau, or temple, was built and dedicated to him. It is whispered that the dedication of this heiau was preceded by human sacrifice and that it is tied to the ritual that bound the Menehune to human form. Jack Doggins was never seen again, and some believe that his bones lie beneath the foundations of the heiau dedicated to him.

The Menehune Today

Though greatly reduced in number, the Menehune continue to live and even thrive on the Hawai'ian islands. Many of them choose to live in their hidden village of Moe'uhane, though some of them live out among the mortals and Kithain who populate the islands. Some even choose to leave the islands, to explore the great world beyond. Very rarely, a Menehune is born to a

human family somewhere off the island, though almost always to couples who are descendants of native Hawai'ians.

Menehune still fish in the oceans and their scared ponds, and hunt in the forests, although these days they come in the guise of human fishermen and hunters, since they are now changelings. Ali'i can be found within the Hawai'ian government, working to restore the traditional ways wherever they can. Hana work the sugar mills and in the fields, and even make crafts that they sell to human tourists. Kahuna work within mortal agencies to restore ancient sites and heiau that have lain in ruins for generations. Kokua can be found as park rangers, working to protect the land and keep tourists from the most sacred places, while some of the exceptionally adventurous even join the military to see the world. Some of the elders fear that this mingling with human society will one day lead to the end of the Menehune culture and way of life, while others see it as their only means of survival and the best way to preserve their heritage.

Moe'uhane, the Village of Dream

The majority of the Menehune of the Hawai'ian Islands make their home in the village of Moe'uhane. The village lies at the base of Mount Wai'ale', past the Alka'i wetlands, which acts as a natural barrier against accidental intruders. Several of the local park rangers are enchanted, and help to protect the village from discovery.

The village lies at the edge of a beautiful lagoon that is fed by a tumbling waterfall. Nearby are fields of taro, a purple, potato-shaped plant that serves as the Menehune's main food source, from which they make poi, a mushy, nutritious staple. The village itself is an old-style Hawai'ian homestead, with grass huts and a traditional heiau, guarded by carved idols that keep evil spirits away. The Menehune gather flowers from nearby parks, which they use to decorate their village and to make leis, which they wear for lu'aus and other spiritual ceremonies.

On rare occasions, a human is brought to the village to participate in one of their ceremonies. This is always a native Hawai'ian, who is fluent in the traditional ways and usually a musician or crafter. The mortal is always enchanted and the next morning awakes on a beach with only hazy memories of her night in Moe'uhane. Still, this experience serves to keep the stories of the Menehune alive among the native peoples of the islands.

Character Creation

Menehune character creation is similar to the process for Kithain characters, but includes a few changes that players and Storytellers will want to be aware of. As with the Nunnehi, Menehune characters begin play with an additional point of Mana, and they have different Backgrounds to choose. In addition, Menehune replace Legacies with Camp and kith with calling.

Camp

A Menehune's Camp replaces the Seelie/ Unseelie dynamic of mainstream changeling society. Menehune fall into one of two camps, Feast or War. The Feast Camp represents the peaceful agrarian nature of the god Lono and other earth